

COMPLETE CHESS LEARNING LIBRARY

# Initiative, Dynamics, and Sacrifices

Use time, activity, open lines, and temporary advantages correctly

TRAINING WORKBOOK

20 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

# Workbook Method

Attempt each page before reopening the matching course-book chapter. Speak answers aloud or write them. The self-score rewards a clear decision rule and the opponent's best reply, not a lucky move guess.

## REVIEW THRESHOLD

8-10: review in one week. 5-7: review tomorrow. 0-4: reread the course chapter now, then retry from a blank board.

Use the workbook again after a game reaches a related structure. Real-game retrieval is the final test.

# 01. Loose Pieces Tell The Truth



INITIATIVE, DYNAMICS, AND SACRIFICES

POSITION PROMPT

Identify what is loose, then ask which forcing move can exploit it.

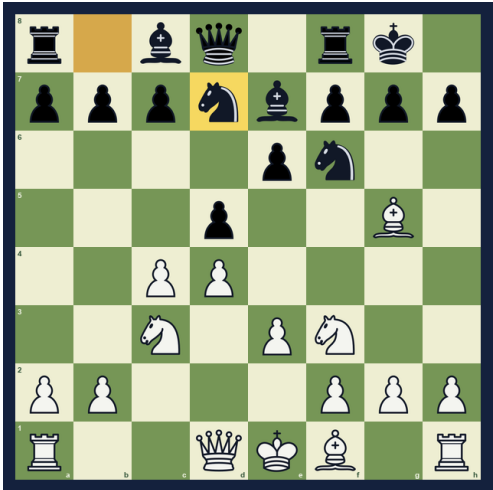
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. d3 Nf6 5. O-O O-O 6. c3 d6 7. Re1

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 02. Compare The Two Kings



INITIATIVE, DYNAMICS, AND SACRIFICES

POSITION PROMPT

Compare access, defenders, and attacking pieces before opening lines.

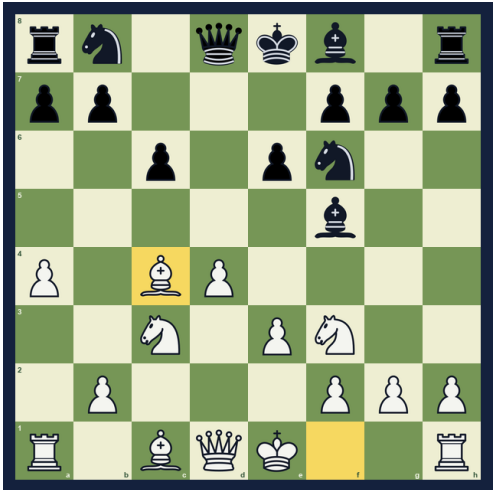
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 Be7 5. Bg5 O-O 6. e3 Nbd7

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
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| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 03. Count Attackers And Defenders



INITIATIVE, DYNAMICS, AND SACRIFICES

POSITION PROMPT

Include hidden defenders, pinned pieces, and the value of the final occupant.

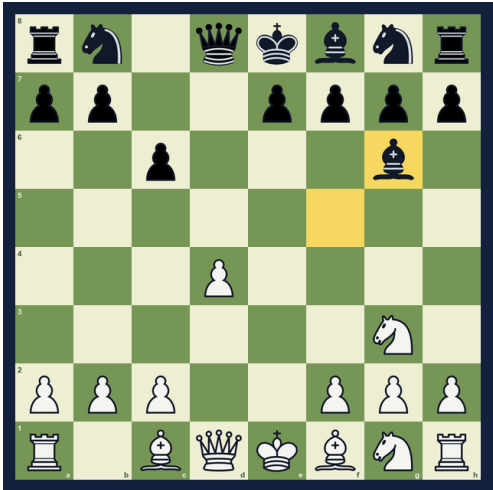
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 dxc4 5. a4 Bf5 6. e3 e6 7. Bxc4

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
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| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 04. Evaluate Before Choosing A Move



INITIATIVE, DYNAMICS, AND SACRIFICES

POSITION PROMPT

Decide what the position needs before deciding how to provide it.

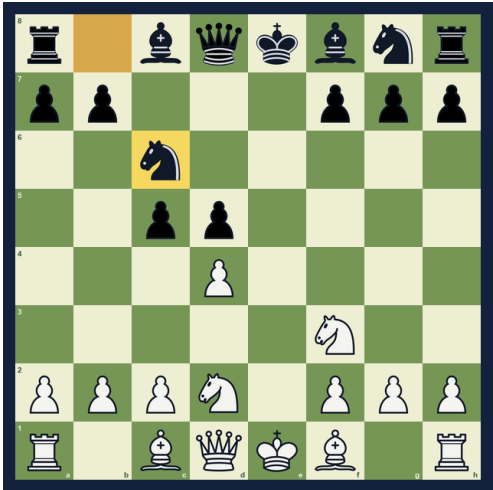
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 dxe4 4. Nxe4 Bf5 5. Ng3 Bg6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
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| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 05. Improve Before You Attack



INITIATIVE, DYNAMICS, AND SACRIFICES

POSITION PROMPT

Bring the least active useful piece into play before forcing the position open.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nd2 c5 4. exd5 exd5 5. Ngf3 Nc6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
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|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 06. Create A Second Weakness



INITIATIVE, DYNAMICS, AND SACRIFICES

POSITION PROMPT

Fix one weakness, then create another where the same defenders cannot serve both.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. Nf3 Nf6 3. Bf4 e6 4. e3 Bd6 5. Bg3 O-O 6. Bd3

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
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| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 07. Use A Space Advantage



INITIATIVE, DYNAMICS, AND SACRIFICES

POSITION PROMPT

Use extra territory to improve pieces and restrict breaks before forcing action.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. d3 d6 7. c3 O-O

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 08. Prepare The Pawn Break



INITIATIVE, DYNAMICS, AND SACRIFICES

POSITION PROMPT

Support the break, occupy the lines it will open, and calculate the opponent's best reaction.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 Be7 5. Bg2 O-O 6. O-O

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
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- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 09. Keep Or Release The Tension?



INITIATIVE, DYNAMICS, AND SACRIFICES

POSITION PROMPT

Compare capture, advance, and waiting before changing the structure.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 10. Use A Passed Pawn As A Tool



INITIATIVE, DYNAMICS, AND SACRIFICES

POSITION PROMPT

Improve support and create play elsewhere while the opponent remains tied to the pawn.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. exd5 cxd5 4. c4 Nf6 5. Nc3 e6 6. Nf3 Be7 7. cxd5 Nxd5 8. Bd3 O-O 9. O-O

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
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- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
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| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 11. Control A Color Complex



INITIATIVE, DYNAMICS, AND SACRIFICES

POSITION PROMPT

Enter through one square, then transfer to another faster than the defense can respond.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 Be7 5. Bg5 O-O 6. e3 Nbd7 7. Qc2 c5 8. cxd5 exd5 9. Bd3

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 12. Exchange The Best Defender



INITIATIVE, DYNAMICS, AND SACRIFICES

POSITION PROMPT

Identify the piece whose removal changes the opponent's entire defensive geometry.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. cxd5 exd5 5. Bg5 Be7 6. e3 O-O 7. Bd3 Nbd7 8. Qc2 Re8 9. Nge2 Nf8 10. O-O

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
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\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 13. Make Your Pieces Work Together



INITIATIVE, DYNAMICS, AND SACRIFICES

POSITION PROMPT

Choose a target or break, then give each piece a compatible job.

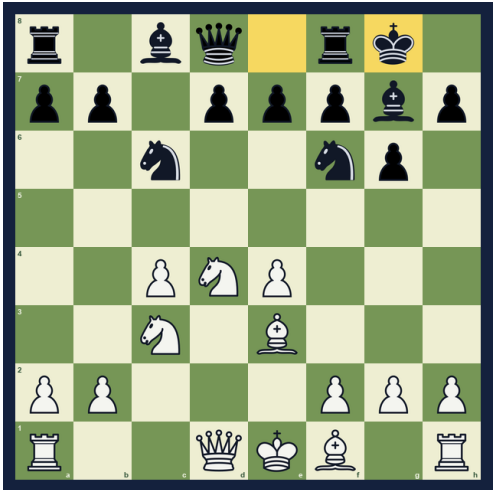
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. c3 Nc6 5. Nf3 Bd7 6. Be2 f6 7. O-O fxe5 8. dxe5 Qc7

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 14. Forcing Moves With Purpose



INITIATIVE, DYNAMICS, AND SACRIFICES

POSITION PROMPT

Generate forcing moves, then reject the ones that improve the opponent's position.

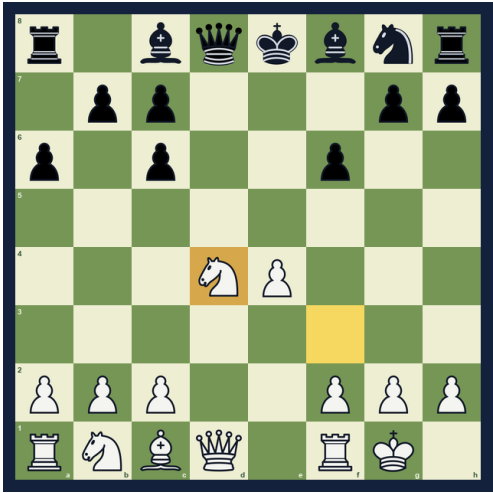
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 g6 5. c4 Bg7 6. Be3 Nf6 7. Nc3 O-O

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
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| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 15. Calculate Until The Position Is Quiet



INITIATIVE, DYNAMICS, AND SACRIFICES

POSITION PROMPT

Continue until checks, captures, and immediate threats no longer control the next move.

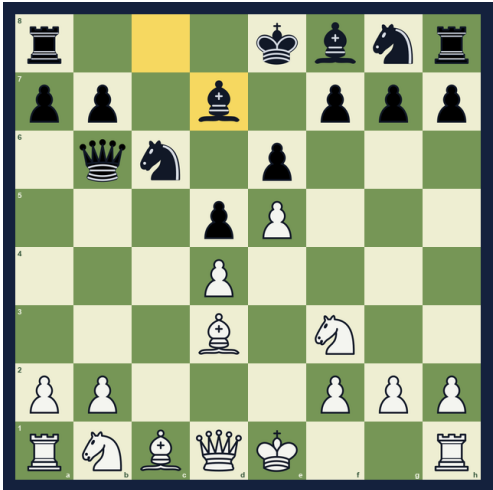
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Bxc6 dxc6 5. O-O f6 6. d4 exd4 7. Nxd4

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
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\_\_\_\_\_

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|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 16. Compare Final Positions



INITIATIVE, DYNAMICS, AND SACRIFICES

POSITION PROMPT

Compare material, king safety, activity, structure, and practical difficulty at the endpoint.

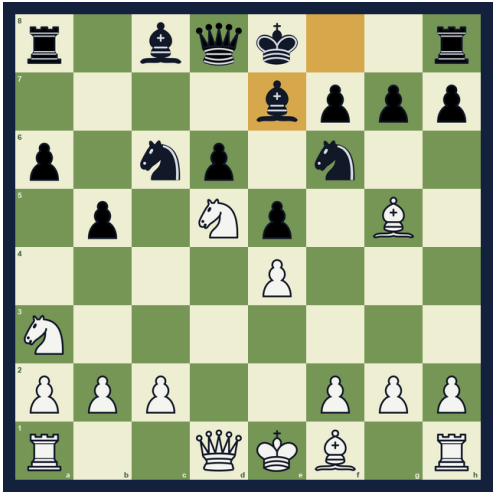
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. c3 Nc6 5. Nf3 Qb6 6. Bd3 cxd4 7. cxd4 Bd7

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
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| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 17. Recognize Tactical Triggers



INITIATIVE, DYNAMICS, AND SACRIFICES

POSITION PROMPT

Loose pieces, exposed kings, overloaded defenders, and opening lines are invitations to search concretely.

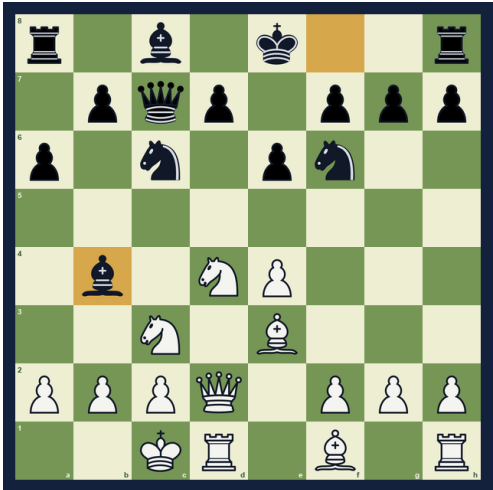
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 e5 6. Ndb5 d6 7. Bg5 a6 8. Na3 b5 9. Nd5 Be7

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
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| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 18. When To Calculate Deeply



INITIATIVE, DYNAMICS, AND SACRIFICES

POSITION PROMPT

Calculate deeply when the move is forcing, irreversible, or changes the evaluation sharply.

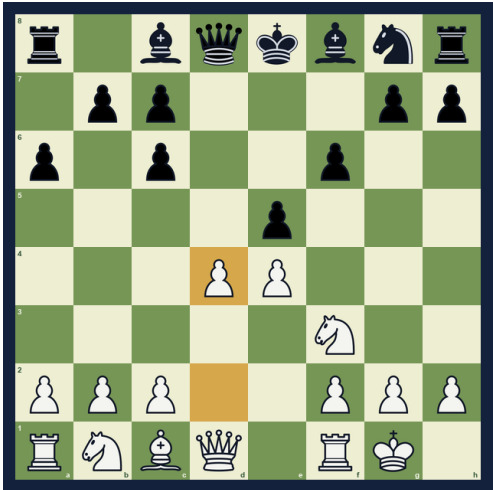
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nc6 5. Nc3 Qc7 6. Be3 a6 7. Qd2 Nf6 8. O-O-O Bb4

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
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| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 19. Convert An Extra Pawn



INITIATIVE, DYNAMICS, AND SACRIFICES

POSITION PROMPT

Activate the king and pieces, restrict counterplay, then use the majority to create a passed pawn.

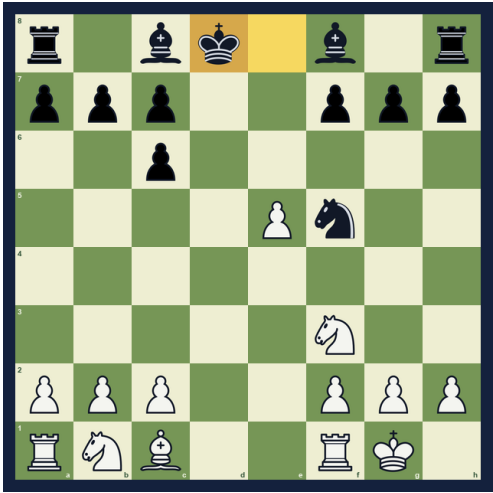
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Bxc6 dxc6 5. O-O f6 6. d4

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
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| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 20. Defend A Worse Position



## INITIATIVE, DYNAMICS, AND SACRIFICES

### POSITION PROMPT

Reduce the opponent's easiest plan while preserving one source of counterplay.

### REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 Nf6 4. O-O Nxe4 5. d4 Nd6 6. Bxc6 dxc6 7. dxe5 Nf5 8. Qxd8+ Kxd8

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
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| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
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| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# Monthly Retention Audit

Select ten random chapters and complete them under a ten-minute total limit. Track the categories you repeatedly miss: threat, candidate, structure, piece job, or forecast.

Do not restart the entire course. Return to the smallest group of chapters that repairs the repeated error, then test again in one week.